

CLAIM SUBMISSION & ELIGIBILITY GUIDELINES

SilverShield Health Plans | Plan Year 2025

1. CLAIM TYPES AND SUBMISSION METHODS

1.1 Professional Claims (CMS-1500)

Professional claims are submitted for services provided by physicians, nurse practitioners, physician assistants, therapists, and other individual providers. In-network providers submit claims electronically using the CMS-1500 format (ANSI 837P EDI transaction). Members seeking reimbursement for out-of-network services may submit paper CMS-1500 forms.

1.2 Institutional Claims (UB-04)

Institutional claims are submitted for services provided by hospitals, skilled nursing facilities, ambulatory surgery centers, and other facility-based providers. Claims are submitted using the UB-04 format (ANSI 837I EDI transaction). Members should not typically need to file institutional claims; facilities file on your behalf.

1.3 Electronic Submission (Preferred)

SilverShield strongly prefers electronic claim submission for faster processing. Payer ID for electronic submissions: SVSH1. Average processing time: 10–14 business days for clean electronic claims.

1.4 Paper Claim Submission

Paper claims should be mailed to: SilverShield Health Plans, Claims Processing Center, P.O. Box 55000, Springfield, IL 62705. Average processing time for paper claims: 30 business days. Include complete member information, provider information, and itemized service details.

2. TIMELY FILING REQUIREMENTS

2.1 In-Network Provider Filing Deadlines

In-network providers must submit claims within the timeframe specified in their provider contract. Standard timely filing limit for in-network providers: 180 days from the date of service.

2.2 Out-of-Network Provider / Member Reimbursement

Claims for out-of-network services must be submitted within 180 days from the date of service. Claims submitted after the timely filing deadline will be denied. Timely filing denials are not eligible for appeal unless proof of timely filing is submitted.

2.3 Coordination of Benefits (COB) Claims

When SilverShield is the secondary payer, the COB claim must be submitted within 180 days of the primary insurer's Explanation of Benefits (EOB) date, or within 365 days of the date of service (whichever comes first).

3. CLAIM ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Member Eligibility

For a claim to be paid, the member must have been actively enrolled and eligible on the date of service. Always verify eligibility before providing services. Providers can verify eligibility at silvershieldhealthplans.com/providers or by calling 1-800-555-0400.

3.2 Covered Service Requirements

The service must be: (a) A covered benefit under the member's specific plan; (b) Medically necessary as defined by SilverShield's clinical criteria; (c) Not excluded under the member's plan; (d) Provided by a licensed provider operating within their scope of practice; (e) Supported by appropriate documentation in the medical record.

3.3 Medical Necessity

Medical necessity is determined based on evidence-based clinical criteria, considering the member's specific condition and circumstances. Services are medically necessary when they are: appropriate for the symptoms, diagnosis, or

treatment of the condition; consistent with generally accepted standards of medical practice; not primarily for the convenience of the member or provider; the most appropriate level of service that can be safely provided.

3.4 Diagnosis Code Requirements

Claims must include the appropriate ICD-10-CM diagnosis codes that support the medical necessity of the services billed. Primary diagnosis should reflect the chief complaint or condition being treated. Up to 12 diagnosis codes may be included on a professional claim. Diagnosis codes must be coded to the highest level of specificity.

4. COMMON DENIAL REASONS AND PREVENTION

4.1 Most Common Denial Reasons

1. **TIMELY FILING:** Claim submitted after the filing deadline. Prevention: submit within 90 days of service.
2. **PRIOR AUTHORIZATION NOT OBTAINED:** Service required PA but none was requested. Prevention: verify PA requirements before providing service.
3. **MEMBER NOT ELIGIBLE:** Member was not enrolled on date of service. Prevention: verify eligibility before each visit.
4. **DUPLICATE CLAIM:** Same claim submitted more than once. Prevention: track claim numbers; wait 30 days before resubmitting.
5. **INCORRECT MEMBER ID:** Member ID on claim does not match enrollment records. Prevention: collect member ID card at each visit.
6. **UNBUNDLING:** Services billed separately that should be billed together under a comprehensive code. Prevention: use CMS and AMA coding guidelines.
7. **MISSING MODIFIER:** Service requires a modifier that was not included. Prevention: review modifier requirements for all billed codes.
8. **MEDICAL NECESSITY NOT ESTABLISHED:** Documentation does not support the service billed. Prevention: ensure medical record documentation supports diagnosis and services.

4.2 Correcting and Resubmitting Claims

If a claim is denied for a correctable error (e.g., incorrect member ID, missing modifier), you may resubmit a corrected claim within 180 days of the original denial. Corrected claims should be marked with claim frequency code '7' in Box 22 of the CMS-1500. Include the original claim number on the corrected submission.

5. EXPLANATION OF BENEFITS (EOB)

5.1 Understanding Your EOB

After every claim is processed, SilverShield sends an Explanation of Benefits (EOB) to both the member and the provider. The EOB shows: Service date and description; Billed amount; SilverShield's allowed amount; Adjustments (contractual adjustment for in-network providers); Plan payment; Member responsibility (deductible, coinsurance, copay); Denial reason (if applicable) and remark codes.

5.2 EOB Remark Codes

Common remark codes: CO-45: Charge exceeds fee schedule/maximum allowable. CO-97: Payment adjusted because this procedure/service is not paid separately. PR-1: Deductible amount applied. PR-2: Coinsurance amount applied. PR-3: Copay amount applied. OA-23: Payment adjusted because charges have been paid by another plan. N130: Consult your plan documents for information on covered services.

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